PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2 OPTION B4

EARLY ELIZABETHAN ENGLAND

1558–1588 • Queen, Government & Religion • Challenges Home & Abroad • Elizabethan Society & Exploration



Plate I: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (1588). Commemorating the defeat of the Spanish invasion fleet; Elizabeth rests her hand upon the global sphere, flanked by the English naval triumph. Woburn Abbey Collection.

HISTORICAL OVERVIEW • 1558–1588 — **MONARCHY, RELIGION & EMPIRE**

Ascending the throne in November 1558 amidst religious tumult, crippling Crown debt of £300,000, and foreign encirclement by France and Scotland, twenty-five-year-old Elizabeth Tudor established a durable Protestant state. Her 1559 Religious Settlement crafted an enduring political compromise between Catholic traditionalism and Calvinist zeal, establishing the English monarch as Supreme Governor of the Church of England while preserving political order across thirty precarious years.

Yet her reign was fiercely tested by domestic rebellion and geopolitical crisis. The flight of Mary, Queen of Scots ignited northern Catholic insurrections, papal excommunication, and deadly assassination conspiracies, while maritime privateering by Francis Drake escalated into outright war with the superpower of Europe—Philip II's Spain. Culminating in the cataclysmic defeat of the 1588 Spanish Armada, this master textbook provides an authoritative 28-page narrative tracing how Elizabeth secured her realm and forged an oceanic Golden Age.

KT 1 Queen, Government & Religion (1558–69) • KT 2 Challenges Home & Abroad (1569–88) • KT 3 Elizabethan Society & Exploration (1558–88)

COURSE SPECIFICATION & DISCIPLINARY DIRECTORY

FULL SYLLABUS ALIGNMENT ACROSS ALL 12 CANONICAL LESSONS (KEY TOPICS 1–3) • OPTION B4

OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION ALIGNMENT

KEY TOPIC 1 QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558–69

KT 1.1 The Situation on Elizabeth's Accession

Spread 1 • pp. 4–5

Ascending the throne in 1558, Elizabeth governed a deeply stratified **society and government**. *Her rule was shadowed by fierce questions regarding her* **legitimacy, gender, marriage**, *yet she possessed formidable intelligence. Elizabeth immediately confronted dangerous structural challenges at home and abroad: acute Crown* **financial weaknesses, religious divisions**, *and the imminent* **French threat** *from Scotland.*

KT 1.2 The 'Settlement' of Religion

Spread 2 • pp. 6–7

To reconcile a fractured nation, Elizabeth enacted the historic **religious settlement (1559)**, *establishing the middle way via the Act of Supremacy and Act of Uniformity with its Royal Injunctions. The newly reformed* **Church of England** *asserted its central role in society, enforcing national conformity, preaching royal obedience, and conducting village parish administration across England.*

KT 1.3 Challenge to the Religious Settlement

Spread 3 • pp. 8–9

The middle way faced aggressive opposition from two extremes. The activist **Puritan challenge** *demanded the eradication of all popish vestments and crucifixes. Concurrently, a dangerous* **Catholic challenge** *gathered momentum, sustained by traditional Northern nobility, Jesuit missionary infiltration, and external encouragement from the* **Papacy and foreign powers** *like Spain and Catholic France.*

KT 1.4 The Problem of Mary, Queen of Scots

Spread 4 • pp. 10–11

Fleeing Scottish rebellion in 1568, Catholic cousin **Mary, Queen of Scots** *arrived in England, possessing a potent dynastic* **claim to the English throne** *that attracted disaffected nobles. Delicate relations between* **Elizabeth and Mary, 1568–69** *deteriorated into permanent house arrest, as Elizabeth wrestled with the profound danger of executing an anointed monarch.*

KEY TOPIC 2 CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

KT 2.1 Plots and Revolts at Home

Spread 5 • pp. 12–13

Northern Catholic grievances erupted in the **Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70**. *Subsequent foreign-backed conspiracies—the* **Ridolfi, Throckmorton and Babington plots**—*sought Elizabeth's assassination, but were systematically dismantled by Sir Francis* **Walsingham and the use of spies**, *directly culminating in the dramatic trial and* **Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587**.

KT 2.2 Relations with Spain

Spread 6 • pp. 14–15

Mounting geopolitical friction ignited deep political, religious and commercial **rivalry** *between Tudor England and Philip II's global empire. Protestant-Catholic antagonism intersected with illicit English trade in the Caribbean, where licensed state* **privateering** *and the lucrative plundering* **activities of Drake** *seizing Spanish silver fleets brought the two powers to the brink of open war.*

KT 2.3 Outbreak of War with Spain, 1585–88

Spread 7 • pp. 16–17

Relations collapsed following direct military intervention in the Spanish **Netherlands** *under the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch and the controversial actions of* **Robert Dudley**, *Earl of Leicester. War became overt in 1587 when Sir Francis* **Drake** *executed the daring naval* **raid on Cadiz**, *destroying vital supplies in the famous 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'.*

KT 2.4 The Armada

Spread 8 • pp. 18–19

Philip II launched colossal **invasion plans** *in 1588 to transport Parma's veteran army across the Channel. Through tactical blunders and English fire-ships at Gravelines, the key events of the* **Spanish Armada** *resulted in disaster. Decisive reasons for the* **English victory** *included superior gunnery, Drake's nimble galleons, defensive communications, and catastrophic North Sea storms.*

KEY TOPIC 3 ELIZABETHAN SOCIETY IN THE AGE OF EXPLORATION, 1558–88

KT 3.1 Education and Leisure

Spread 9 • pp. 20–21

Humanist ideas drove an expansion of grammar school **education** *for wealthy boys, literacy, and dame schools, while girls remained confined to domestic tuition. Elizabethan leisure reflected social hierarchy, from violent* **sport, pastimes** *like bear-baiting and hawking to the wildly popular secular flowering of purpose-built public* **theatre** *featuring Marlowe and early Shakespeare.*

KT 3.2 The 'Problem' of the Poor

Spread 10 • pp. 22–23

Bad harvests, population growth, rack-renting, and sheep enclosure caused a alarming increase in **poverty and vagabondage**. *Fear of rural disorder transformed traditional moral condemnation into changing legislative* **attitudes and policies**, *distinguishing between the 'deserving' and 'idle' poor, and establishing local poor rates through landmark Elizabethan Poor Laws.*

KT 3.3 Exploration and Voyages of Discovery

Spread 11 • pp. 24–25

Maritime expansion was propelled by revolutionary **new technology on ships and sailing**, *including the astrolabe, triangular lateen sails, and the commercial drive to* **expand trade** *beyond European cloth markets. National prestige surged with* **Drake's circumnavigation of the globe** *(1577–80), reaping immense plunder and establishing England as a formidable oceanic maritime power.*

KT 3.4 Attempted Colonisation of Virginia

Spread 12 • pp. 26–27

Imperial ambitions motivated the **attempted colonisation of Virginia**, *spearheaded by Sir Walter* **Raleigh** *to challenge Spanish hegemony and establish permanent New World bases. Despite intense royal backing, the* **failure of the first settlement** *at Roanoke resulted from poor planning, hostile Indigenous relations, severe supply starvation, and the complete disappearance of the 'Lost Colony'.*

CHRONOLOGICAL MILESTONE SPINE & TURNING POINTS

18 DEFINING CAUSAL TURNING POINTS ACROSS ALL 12 CANONICAL LESSONS • OPTION B4

CHRONOLOGICAL HIGHWAY

17 Nov 1558

Accession of Queen Elizabeth I & Appointment of William Cecil

Following the death of Mary I, twenty-five-year-old Elizabeth Tudor ascends the throne, inheriting £300,000 in debt; Sir William Cecil is appointed Principal Secretary.

8 May 1559

The Elizabethan Religious Settlement Passed by Parliament

The Act of Supremacy establishes Elizabeth as "Supreme Governor" of the Church of England; the Act of Uniformity imposes the 1559 Book of Common Prayer and 1s recusancy fines.

24 Jun 1559

Royal Injunctions Enforce Uniformity & Church Visitations

Royal Injunctions mandate English liturgy, enforce clerical vestments, ban unauthorized preaching, and initiate nation-wide inspections by royal commissioners.

26 Mar 1566

The Lambeth Vestments Crisis & Archbishop Parker's Advertisements

Archbishop Matthew Parker commands London clergy to wear the surplice; thirty-seven Puritan ministers refuse on grounds of conscience and are stripped of their livings.

16 May 1568

Mary, Queen of Scots Flees into England Across the Solway Firth

Escaping imprisonment at Lochleven following defeat at Langside, Mary Stuart lands at Workington in Cumbria, creating an immediate dynastic crisis for the English Crown.

Oct 1568

The York and Westminster Inquiries Convene over the Casket Letters

Scottish Protestant lords present the mysterious Casket Letters implicating Mary in Lord Darnley's murder; Cecil engineers an inconclusive verdict to detain Mary indefinitely.

Nov 1569

The Revolt of the Northern Earls (The Rising of the North)

The Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland seize Durham Cathedral, celebrate Catholic Mass, and march south to free Mary Stuart; the rebellion is crushed and 450 rebels executed.

25 Feb 1570

Pope Pius V Issues the Papal Bull Regnans in Excelsis

The Pope excommunicates Elizabeth as a heretic, absolving all Catholic subjects from their oath of allegiance and transforming English Catholics into potential traitors in law.

Mar 1571

The Ridolfi Plot Uncovered by Elizabeth's Intelligence Network

Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi conspires with the Duke of Norfolk and Spain to assassinate Elizabeth; Norfolk is tried for high treason and executed on Tower Hill in 1572.

1572

The Vagabonds Act Introduces Compulsory Parish Poor Rates

Parliament mandates harsh physical punishments (whipping and ear-boring) for idle vagrants while establishing the first statutory compulsory poor relief system administered by JPs.

26 Sep 1580

Francis Drake Completes Global Circumnavigation in the Golden Hind

Drake returns to Plymouth with £400,000 in seized Spanish treasure; Elizabeth defies King Philip II by boarding the Golden Hind at Deptford and knighting Drake in April 1581.

Nov 1583

The Throckmorton Plot Exposed & The Bond of Association Formed

Francis Throckmorton confesses under torture on the rack to a French Catholic invasion plan backed by Spanish money; Council leaders establish the lethal Bond of Association.

1584

Walter Raleigh Granted Royal Patent for North American Colonisation

Elizabeth grants Raleigh a charter to explore and settle unclaimed lands; Arthur Barlowe's expedition scouts Roanoke Island and returns to London praising "Virginia".

20 Aug 1585

The Treaty of Nonsuch Commits English Troops to the Netherlands

Following William of Orange's assassination and the Treaty of Joinville, Elizabeth signs the Treaty of Nonsuch, sending 7,400 soldiers under Leicester, entering direct war with Spain.

Jul 1586

The Babington Plot Intercepted: Walsingham Cracks the Cipher

Sir Francis Walsingham intercepts and deciphers letters hidden in beer barrels between Anthony Babington and Mary Stuart, obtaining Mary's explicit written consent to regicide.

8 Feb 1587

Execution of Mary, Queen of Scots at Fotheringhay Castle

Following parliamentary petitions and Cecil's pressure, Elizabeth signs the death warrant; Mary Stuart is beheaded in the Great Hall, removing the Catholic dynastic figurehead.

19 Apr 1587

Drake's Raid on Cadiz ("Singeing the King of Spain's Beard")

Sir Francis Drake leads an audacity-fueled preemptive naval assault on Cadiz harbour, destroying over thirty Spanish warships and burning thousands of seasoned oak barrel staves.

8 Aug 1588

The Battle of Gravelines & The Dispersal of the Spanish Armada

English fireships break the Armada crescent off Calais; race-built galleons batter Spanish hulls at close range; westerly gale winds drive the surviving invasion fleet into the North Sea.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

How did an inexperienced queen secure an impoverished and divided England amidst acute foreign encirclement in 1558?

[1.1] *1558*

Hatfield Oak to the Tower: Inheriting Bankruptcy and Cecil's Partnership

> ***"Why did inherited debt and foreign loans create an immediate crisis for the new Queen?"***

In November 1558, twenty-five-year-old Elizabeth Tudor ascended the English throne following the death of her Catholic half-sister Mary I. The young Queen inherited an impoverished, vulnerable realm burdened by an astronomical **£300,000 Crown debt**, largely accumulated through disastrous Tudor military interventions in French wars and debased coinage that wrecked the national currency. Because the Crown's ordinary annual revenue stood at barely £286,000, English monarchs were forced to secure foreign **Antwerp loans (14% interest)** from European merchant bankers to cover basic administrative expenditure. Seeking immediate administrative competence and political stability, Elizabeth acted decisively on accession day by appointing William **Cecil appointed Principal Secretary**, forging an indispensable political partnership that directed English statecraft for forty years.

[1.2] *1558*

The Royal Court & Privy Council: Patronage, Factional Flattery and the 19-Man Council

> ***"How did Elizabeth use patronage and factional competition to secure political control?"***

Tudor monarchical governance was rooted in divine right, yet the Crown possessed no standing national army or professional police force. Sovereign power was instead exercised through an elite **19-man Privy Council** comprising senior nobles and experienced statesmen who met daily at court to manage national defense, taxation, international diplomacy, and the enforcement of parliamentary statutes. To ensure political stability, Elizabeth skillfully maintained a delicate **factional balance at court**, preventing ambitious courtiers like William Cecil and Robert Dudley from monopolizing royal influence. The Queen bound the landed aristocracy to her regime through royal patronage, distributing lucrative offices, titles, leases, and **monopolies & royal licences** that granted exclusive trading privileges in exchange for unswerving political loyalty.

[1.3] *1558*

Challenges of Gender & Marriage: Female Monarchical Rule, Legitimacy and Knox's Opposition

> ***"Why did challenges to Elizabeth's gender and legitimacy threaten domestic stability?"***

Elizabeth's monarchical title was bitterly challenged by deep-seated sixteenth-century patriarchal prejudice and religious doubts surrounding her legitimacy. Roman Catholic canon law maintained that Henry VIII's marriage to Catherine of Aragon was indissoluble, resulting in widespread **papal rejection of Anne Boleyn** as an adulterous union. Consequently, devout European Catholics viewed Elizabeth as illegitimate and barred by divine law from inheriting the English crown. This illegitimacy was compounded by Henry VIII's own statutory legislation, specifically the **1536 Succession Act bar** passed following Anne Boleyn's execution, which formally bastardized Elizabeth. As an unmarried female ruler, she faced relentless **pressure to produce Protestant heir** from MPs and councillors who dreaded civil war should she die without issue, a dilemma she countered by declaring herself married to England.

[1.4] *1559*

Whitehall to the Shires: Reluctant Parliaments and Unpaid Country JPs

"Why was Elizabeth entirely dependent on unpaid local gentry to enforce royal authority?"

Beyond the royal court at Whitehall, the Tudor Crown depended entirely on local gentry to enforce statutory law across England's counties. County security was organized by appointed Lords Lieutenant, who raised local **Lords Lieutenant county militias** during national emergencies. Daily governance fell upon wealthy, **unpaid Justices of the Peace**, who sat in quarterly sessions to punish felonies, repair roads, and enforce religious laws. Meanwhile, Parliament was not a permanent governing body but an occasional assembly summoned only when the monarch required extraordinary revenue or new legislation. While Elizabeth jealously defended her royal prerogative over religion and foreign affairs, constitutional convention dictated that extraordinary **taxation granted solely by MPs** could authorize Crown subsidies, granting the House of Commons vital fiscal leverage throughout her reign.

[1.5] *1558–1560*

The Catholic Pincer: The Surrender of Calais and French Troops on the Tweed

"Why did the Auld Alliance and the loss of Calais make England vulnerable to foreign invasion?"

In foreign diplomacy, Elizabeth inherited an exceptionally perilous geopolitical encirclement by Catholic superpowers. England had suffered the humiliating **loss of Calais (January 1558)**, its final military foothold on continental Europe, during Mary I's disastrous French war. The loss shattered English commercial prestige and left the southern coastline defenseless against potential cross-Channel invasion fleets launched from northern French ports. The danger was intensified to the north by the presence of battle-hardened **French garrison troops in Scotland**, commanded by regent Mary of Guise. Her daughter, Mary Stuart, was married to the French King Francis II and defiantly displayed the **quartered English royal arms** on her official heraldic crest, openly proclaiming Elizabeth an illegitimate usurper and asserting her own rightful claim to England.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Executive Institutionalisation • Factional Patronage and Cecil's Bureaucratic Partnership**

Elizabeth overcame the structural weakness of inherited bankruptcy and patriarchal prejudice by balancing rival court factions and binding the aristocracy through royal patronage.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

To what extent was the 1559 Religious Settlement an enduring theological compromise designed to prevent civil war?

[2.1] *1558–1559*

A Fractured Realm: Marian Burnings, Geneva Exiles and the Search for Peace

"Why did England's geographic and political divisions make a religious settlement essential?"

Upon her accession in 1558, Elizabeth inherited an intensely divided realm traumatized by decades of rapid religious swings under her predecessors. The influential **conservative north & western gentry** remained devoutly attached to traditional Roman Catholic rites, Latin liturgy, and papal authority, while London and southeastern mercantile ports had embraced radical Reformation ideas following heavy commercial contact with Protestant Europe. Following Mary I's execution of nearly three hundred Protestants, **radical returning Marian exiles** flocked back from Geneva and Zurich, demanding a thoroughly purified Calvinist state church stripped of all papist rituals. Furthermore, entrenched **Marian bishops in Lords** held twenty-six parliamentary votes and fiercely resisted any Protestant settlement, presenting Elizabeth with a formidable constitutional hurdle in reforming the national church.

[2.2] *1559*

The Crown Restored: The Act of Supremacy and the Title of Supreme Governor

"Why did Elizabeth choose the title 'Supreme Governor' instead of 'Supreme Head'?"

Passed by Parliament in May 1559, the landmark Act of Supremacy re-established the English Crown's formal independence from the Papacy. In an astute political compromise designed to placate Catholics who believed only the Pope could head Christ's Church, Elizabeth rejected Henry VIII's aggressive title of 'Supreme Head' and instead adopted the diplomatic **'Supreme Governor' compromise title** of the Church of England. The statute instituted a rigid **compulsory oath for clergy**, requiring all parish priests, university fellows, and royal magistrates to swear allegiance to Elizabeth's spiritual supremacy on pain of losing their livelihoods. When conservative churchmen mounted resistance, the Crown enforced compliance decisively, resulting in **all Marian bishops deprived** of their ecclesiastical sees except one, replacing them with reliable, loyal Protestant reformers.

[2.3] *1559*

The Altar of Compromise: The Act of Uniformity, Liturgy and One-Shilling Recusancy

"How did the Act of Uniformity attempt to compromise between Catholic and Protestant worship?"

Enacted alongside supremacy legislation, the 1559 Act of Uniformity established an obligatory national framework for public worship in every parish church. The law introduced a **compulsory 1559 Prayer Book** based on Thomas Cranmer's Edwardian liturgy, requiring all English subjects to attend Sunday church services. Those who refused to conform were labeled recusants and subjected to a punitive **one-shilling recusancy fine** per missed service. To foster theological consensus, the liturgy incorporated **deliberate communion ambiguity**, deliberately blending the 1549 and 1552 communion wordings so that traditional Catholics could believe in transubstantiation while Protestants treated the sacrament as a spiritual commemoration. Furthermore, the Ornaments Rubric retained traditional clerical vestments, preserving familiar visual grandeur to prevent widespread rural Catholic rebellion across northern shires.

[2.4] *1559*

The Royal Injunctions: Crucifix Bans, Clerical Surplices and Church Visitations

> *"How did the Royal Injunctions establish central royal control over local parish life?"*

In the summer of 1559, William Cecil issued a comprehensive regulatory code of **fifty-seven royal directives** to govern the day-to-day administration of the Elizabethan Church. These injunctions ordered parish clergy to preach royal supremacy at quarterly sermons, condemn papal jurisdiction, and maintain an accessible **English Bible in every church** so parishioners could study scripture in their vernacular tongue. The directives moved systematically against superstitious practices, ordering that traditional Catholic **pilgrimages & fake miracles banned** across every diocese. Churchwardens were instructed to remove idolatrous shrines and monuments, while clerical marriages were tightly regulated, requiring prospective brides to be rigorously interviewed and approved by two local Justices of the Peace and the diocesan bishop before wedding vows.

[2.5] *1559–1560s*

The Pulpit of the Realm: Church Courts, Royal Homilies and Community Feasts

> *"How effectively did royal visitations and Church courts enforce conformity across England?"*

To ensure nationwide conformity, the Crown dispatched **125 visitation commissioners** across the realm in the autumn of 1559 to inspect dioceses, enforce the injunctions, and administer the Oath of Supremacy. While approximately **four hundred clergy resignations** occurred among senior Catholic academics and cathedral dignitaries who refused the oath, the vast majority of ordinary parish priests conformed to retain their church livings. The Church of England functioned as a vital instrument of social cohesion and Crown control through **parish church court supervision**, which adjudicated moral offenses, slander, marriage disputes, and wills. Parishes served as primary centers of community charity and social welfare, ensuring that religious uniformity reinforced royal political stability and civic obedience across the entire realm.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **The Via Media Compromise • Deliberate Doctrinal Ambiguity and Monarchical Supremacy**

By adopting the title Supreme Governor and blending Protestant liturgy with traditional ceremonial vestments, Elizabeth established state control while averting violent religious civil strife.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

Why did ideological opposition from Puritan zealots and Catholic traditionalists threaten Elizabeth's middle way in the 1560s?

[3.1] *1559–1563*

The Puritan Challenge: Beliefs, Demands and the Crucifix Controversy

> ***"Why did Puritan religious demands pose a direct challenge to Elizabeth's royal authority?"***

Radical Protestant reformers, commonly called Puritans, believed Elizabeth's 1559 Religious Settlement had stopped halfway and compromised with Catholic idolatry. Deeply shaped by **Geneva Calvinist influence**, returning Marian exiles demanded that the Church of England be purified of all unscriptural ceremonies, crucifixes, organs, and wedding rings, advocating a strict church governance centered on biblical preaching and predestination theology. In the 1563 Convocation, zealous Puritan clergy mounted a fierce **demand to abolish holy days** and saint feast celebrations, coming within one vote of passing radical liturgical reforms. Elizabeth viewed these Presbyterian demands as an intolerable **threat to royal prerogative**, firmly insisting that religious doctrine was a matter of state over which the monarch held absolute, divinely ordained control.

[3.2] *1566*

The Vestments Controversy: Archbishop Parker, the Surplice Dispute and Puritan Defiance

> ***"Why did the dispute over clergy vestments become a major test of Elizabeth's control?"***

Friction erupted into open clerical rebellion over church ceremonial attire. Puritans violently objected to **compulsory clergy surplices**, condemning the garments as "rags of Rome" and popish idolatry. In 1566, Archbishop Matthew Parker published the *Book of Advertisements*, enforcing the strict **white linen surplice requirement** during all religious sacraments and demanding that all parish ministers conform to uniform church dress standards. When Parker held an inspection of London clergy at Lambeth Palace, thirty-seven ministers refused to wear the vestments, resulting in **thirty-seven London priests sacked** and deprived of their livings. Despite this purge, Puritan dissent deepened, encouraging radical Presbyterian leaders like Thomas Cartwright to challenge the monarchical appointment of bishops and demand democratic, elder-led church governance across the country.

[3.3] *1559–1568*

The Catholic Stronghold: Northern Magnates, Manor Altars and Church Papists

> ***"Why was Elizabeth able to tolerate moderate Catholic non-conformity during the early 1560s?"***

The domestic Catholic threat initially appeared muted, as thousands of traditional believers became **church papists attending services** on Sundays to pay lip service to the law and avoid fines, while secretly observing traditional Catholic sacraments at home. In the remote northern and western shires, **lax local JPs in north** counties deliberately turned a blind eye to widespread Catholic recusancy and unlicenced priests. Elizabeth adopted an intentionally cautious, conciliatory domestic policy during the 1560s, famously declaring that she had no desire to "make **tolerant 'windows into men's souls'**" as long as subjects maintained outward political loyalty. However, this fragile religious truce collapsed rapidly after 1568, when the arrival of Mary Stuart and papal intervention transformed domestic Catholic sentiment into open rebellion.

[3.4] *1562–1568*

The Counter-Reformation Shadow: Alba's Tercios, Douai Seminaries and the Jesuit Mission

> ***"Why did the arrival of Alba's Spanish army in the Netherlands alarm the English Privy Council?"***

In continental Europe, shifting religious rivalries created grave strategic perils for Protestant England. The outbreak of the brutal **French Wars of Religion (1562)** temporarily neutralized the threat of French invasion by embroiling the Valois monarchy in domestic sectarian warfare, allowing Elizabeth to send military subsidies to aid beleaguered Huguenot Protestants in their coastal strongholds. Far more dangerous was the Dutch crisis across the Channel, where King Philip II dispatched **10,000 Spanish troops in Netherlands** under the ruthless Duke of Alba in 1567 to crush a Calvinist rebellion. Alba instituted the infamous **Council of Troubles brutality**, executing thousands of Protestants and stationing an elite army within striking distance of the English coast, terrifying Elizabeth's council.

[3.5] *1568–1569*

The Genoese Loan: Spanish Silver, Trade Embargoes and the Edge of War

> ***"How did the seizure of the Genoese Loan push England and Spain closer to open conflict?"***

In November 1568, Anglo-Spanish tensions escalated dramatically when four Spanish transport ships carrying Italian gold bullion sought refuge from stormy weather and privateers in English ports. Seeking **£85,000 Italian bullion storm shelter** in Plymouth and Southampton, the vessels carried substantial pay destined for Alba's restless, mutinous Spanish troops fighting Dutch Protestant rebels across the English Channel. Urged on by William Cecil, Elizabeth performed an audacious diplomatic seizure when the **Queen claims Italian bank loan**, arguing that since the money belonged to Genoese bankers until delivered, England would borrow it herself. Furious at this humiliation, **Alba imposes English trade embargo**, impounding English merchant ships in Antwerp, crippling London's cloth trade, and nearly precipitating open Anglo-Spanish warfare.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Confessional Polarisation • The Radicalisation of Conscience and Foreign Geopolitical Pressure**

The Elizabethan settlement was squeezed between uncompromising Calvinists demanding total reformation and traditionalists sustained by continental Catholic armies and Douai seminaries.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

How did the arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in 1568 transform Elizabeth's dynastic security into a permanent national crisis?

[4.1] *1560–1565*

Two Anointed Queens: The Scottish Succession, Bloodline Rivalry and the French Pincer

> ***"Why did Mary Stuart's royal ancestry and marriage choices threaten Elizabeth's security?"***

In May 1568, Mary, Queen of Scots arrived unexpectedly in England, confronting Elizabeth with her most acute dynastic dilemma. As Henry VIII's great-niece possessing unblemished **Margaret Tudor granddaughter lineage**, Mary held a formidable hereditary claim to the English crown, backed by European Catholic monarchs who viewed the childless Elizabeth as an illegitimate Tudor pretender without legal succession rights. However, Mary had been forced out of Scotland following the **suspicious murder of Mary's husband**, Lord Darnley, and her subsequent scandalous marriage to the chief suspect, the Earl of Bothwell. Arriving as an impoverished political refugee, Mary instantly became a dangerous, **legitimate Catholic figurehead** for disaffected English nobles eager to depose Elizabeth and restore papal religious supremacy across the realm.

[4.2] *1567*

Kirk o' Field: Gunpowder Treason, Bothwell's Ambition and Darnley's Murder

> ***"Why did Darnley's murder and Mary's marriage to Bothwell ruin her authority in Scotland?"***

Mary's downfall in Scotland was precipitated by the sensational scandal surrounding Lord Darnley's violent death in February 1567. While recuperating from illness outside Edinburgh, Darnley was killed in the **Kirk o' Field gunpowder explosion**, his strangled body discovered in an adjacent orchard. Public outrage escalated when Mary abruptly married the ambitious Earl of Bothwell, the universal prime suspect in the murder. The scandalous marriage alienated the Scottish public and triggered a widespread **Scottish Protestant rebellion** led by Confederate lords. Royalist forces were defeated at Carberry Hill, after which the **Scottish nobility force abdication** of Mary, imprisoning her in the island castle of Lochleven and crowning her thirteen-month-old Protestant son James VI under the regency of the Earl of Moray.

[4.3] *1567–1568*

Lochleven to the Solway: Abdication, Island Dungeon and Mary's Desperate Flight

> ***"Why did Mary's unexpected arrival in England present Elizabeth with an impossible dilemma?"***

In July 1567, while held captive at Lochleven Castle, Scottish rebel lords secured the **forced abdication for infant James VI**, coercing Mary into surrendering her crown. Ten months later, she made a daring midnight escape from the island fortress, rallying six thousand royalist loyalists before suffering decisive defeat at Langside. Desperate to evade execution, Mary made a hurried **fishing boat crossing to Workington** on 16 May 1568. Expecting royal sanctuary and English military assistance from Elizabeth to reclaim her Scottish throne, Mary found herself immediately detained. Elizabeth faced an impossible constitutional dilemma: sheltering a murder suspect invited Scottish hostility, yet holding an **anointed monarch under house arrest** violated divine right, sparking fierce condemnation from Catholic Europe and domestic rebellion.

[4.4] *1568–1569*

The York Inquiry: The Mysterious Casket Letters and Cecil's Stalemate

> *"Why did Elizabeth choose an inconclusive verdict rather than declaring Mary guilty or innocent?"*

To resolve Mary's legal status without directly judging an anointed queen, Elizabeth convened an inquiry at York and Westminster in late 1568. Scottish Protestant regents presented **eight French Casket love letters**, allegedly written by Mary to Bothwell, purporting to prove her direct complicity in Darnley's murder. Mary's defenders passionately asserted the documents were fraudulent forgeries manufactured by Scottish rebels. Elizabeth carefully controlled proceedings, enforcing a strict **refusal of direct cross-examination** by preventing Mary from appearing in person or inspecting the original letters. In January 1569, Cecil announced that **no verdict justifies detention** on either side, declaring the murder charges not proven but leaving Mary in indefinite English custody to neutralize her dangerous political threat permanently.

[4.5] *1569*

The Gilded Cage: Bolton Castle, Northern Vigilance and the Threat to Whitehall

> *"Why did Mary Stuart's presence in England inevitably lead to armed Catholic rebellion?"*

For the next nineteen years, Mary was held in remote, heavily fortified midland castles, placed under the honorable custody of George Talbot and securely **guarded by Earl of Shrewsbury**. While permitted a royal household, Mary's presence inside England acted as a potent, destabilizing catalyst, serving as an irresistible **magnet for northern Catholic discontent** and foreign Catholic conspiracies against Elizabeth's life. Disaffected English courtiers rapidly gravitated toward the captive Scottish queen, hatching the ill-fated **Duke of Norfolk court marriage plot** in 1569 to secure the English succession and overthrow Cecil. When Elizabeth discovered and forbade the scheme, the crisis ignited the Northern Rebellion, ushering in two decades of mortal Catholic treason and assassination conspiracies against the Queen.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Dynastic Entrapment • The Legitimate Catholic Alternative and Sovereign Impasse**

As Henry VII's great-granddaughter and an anointed Catholic sovereign, Mary's presence on English soil created an inescapable focal point for Catholic rebellion and foreign invasion.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

Why did escalating assassination conspiracies compel Elizabeth to take the unprecedented step of executing an anointed monarch?

[5.1] *1569–1570*

The Northern Fire: Catholic Earls, Durham Cathedral and Tudor Vengeance

> ***"Why did the Northern Earls fail to overthrow Elizabeth despite capturing Durham Cathedral?"***

In November 1569, traditional Catholic noblemen in northern England launched an armed insurrection against Elizabeth's Protestant regime. Led by the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland, rebel forces marched into Durham, tore down Protestant communion tables, and celebrated a defiant **Latin Mass at Durham Cathedral**, attempting to overthrow Cecil, marry Mary Stuart to Norfolk, and re-establish Roman Catholicism. However, expected foreign **Spanish troops fail to land** at Hartlepool, leaving northern rebels isolated when royal forces under the Earl of Sussex marched north. The earls fled into Scotland, and Elizabeth exacted ruthless royal vengeance by ordering **four hundred and fifty executions** of ordinary peasant rebels in village squares across northern counties, decisively crushing northern feudal autonomy.

[5.2] *1570–1572*

Regnans in Excelsis & The Ridolfi Conspiracy: Intercepted Ciphers and Norfolk's Axe

> ***"How did the 1570 Papal Bull transform the legal and political danger facing English Catholics?"***

In February 1570, Pope Pius V issued the incendiary papal bull **Regnans in Excelsis excommunication**, declaring Elizabeth an illegitimate heretic, releasing English subjects from their oaths of allegiance, and commanding Catholics to depose her. Emboldened by papal backing, conspirators launched the 1571 Ridolfi Plot, using wealthy **Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi courier** to coordinate high-treason messages between Mary Stuart, Madrid, and Rome. The conspiracy planned for King Philip II to land ten thousand Spanish troops at Harwich, depose Elizabeth, and crown Mary alongside Thomas Howard. Cecil's intelligence service intercepted encrypted letters and cracked the conspiracy, resulting in the Duke of **Norfolk beheaded on Tower Hill** in June 1572, while Parliament demanded Mary Stuart's immediate execution for treason.

[5.3] *1583–1584*

The Jesuit Shadow & Throckmorton's Confession: The Rack and the Bond of Association

> ***"Why did the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot lead to harsher anti-Catholic measures?"***

In 1583, Sir Francis Walsingham uncovered another dangerous international Catholic conspiracy aimed at assassinating Elizabeth. The Throckmorton Plot revolved around an ambitious **French Catholic invasion plan** organized by the Duke of Guise, who intended to land troops in Sussex while English Catholic aristocrats rose in rebellion, financed directly when King **Philip II provides 200,000 ducats** in Spanish royal subsidies to overthrow Protestant rule. Intercepting ciphered correspondence through courier Francis Throckmorton, Walsingham broke the plot before troops sailed, expelling Spanish ambassador Bernardino de Mendoza from England. Outraged by repeated assassination conspiracies against Elizabeth, Cecil and Walsingham drafted the radical 1584 **Bond of Association traitor oath**, legally obliging loyal signatories to execute anyone in whose name regicide was attempted.

[5.4] *1586*

The Beer Barrel Cryptograms: Walsingham's Trap and Babington's Fatal Sign-Off

> *"How did Walsingham use espionage and deciphered correspondence to trap Mary Stuart?"*

In 1586, young Catholic gentleman Anthony Babington hatched a fatal conspiracy to murder Elizabeth and liberate Mary Stuart from Chartley Manor. Unbeknownst to the plotters, Walsingham turned brewer Gilbert Gifford into a double agent, smuggling secret **letters in waterproof beer barrels** straight into the hands of government cryptographer Thomas Phelippes, who deciphered the ciphered correspondence for the Crown. Master cryptographer **Phelippes decodes gallows cipher**, forging a postscript with a gallows emblem to discover the identities of co-conspirators. Mary sealed her doom on 17 July 1586 by penning a fateful letter containing **explicit approval of regicide**, authorizing Elizabeth's assassination and providing concrete documentary treason evidence that justified putting an anointed Scottish queen on trial.

[5.5] *1587*

The Great Hall at Fotheringhay: The Regicide Dilemma and Mary's Red Execution

> *"Why was Elizabeth so reluctant to execute Mary Queen of Scots despite proven treason?"*

In October 1586, Mary was brought before forty-six commissioners at Fotheringhay Castle under the **Act for the Queen's Safety trial**, where she was found guilty of imagining Elizabeth's death. Elizabeth delayed signing the death warrant for months, dreading the terrifying international precedent of executing a divinely crowned monarch and fearing violent military retaliation from King Philip II of Spain. After Elizabeth finally signed the warrant, the Privy Council dispatched it secretly without her knowledge. On 8 February 1587, Mary knelt before the **Fotheringhay Castle Great Hall block**, wearing liturgical crimson to project **divine right monarchical martyrdom**. Her dramatic execution removed the Catholic figurehead from English politics, convincing Philip II that direct invasion was the only way to re-Catholicize England.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Preemptive Surveillance • Cryptanalysis, Agent Provocateurs, and State Security Law**

Faced with papal excommunication and systematic assassination plots, Walsingham's intelligence apparatus weaponised intercepted ciphers to force the execution of Mary Stuart.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

How did maritime raiding and covert proxy intervention escalate an undeclared cold war into direct military conflict with Spain?

[6.1] *1570–1577*

The Spanish Superpower: Philip II's Empire, the Dutch Revolt and English Sympathy

> ***"Why did Spanish control of the Netherlands threaten English trade and security?"***

Geopolitical and commercial friction steadily eroded the traditional Anglo-Spanish alliance throughout the 1570s. English strategic security was fundamentally jeopardized by the Spanish Netherlands directly across the English Channel, where the **Antwerp deep-water ports threat** gave King Philip II a potential forward staging ground for seaborne invasion fleets capable of striking London within hours during favorable easterly winds. When Dutch Protestants launched the **William of Orange Protestant rebellion** against Spanish rule, Elizabeth covertly intervened to prolong the conflict and sap Spanish strength. English merchants aided the rebels by sheltering and **funding Sea Beggars privateers** in English ports, allowing them to seize Spanish treasure convoys and attack coastal garrisons without committing English soldiers to an expensive continental land war.

[6.2] *1570–1579*

The Silver Route: John Hawkins, Caribbean Privateering and the Cacafuego Loot

> ***"Why did English privateering in the Caribbean inflame diplomatic tensions with Spain?"***

In the Americas, English merchant mariners aggressively challenged the rigid **Spanish monopoly on American bullion** and Caribbean trade. King Philip II legally prohibited foreign vessels from trading with Spanish colonies, forcing English captains like John Hawkins and Francis Drake to engage in illicit smuggling and open maritime piracy against heavily laden Spanish treasure fleets carrying silver and gold. In 1572, Drake staged the audacious **Nombre de Dios mule train ambush** on the Panamanian isthmus, capturing fifteen tons of Spanish silver and establishing his terrifying reputation as 'El Draque'. Operating through secret syndicate partnerships, the **Queen licences legal piracy**, covertly financing privateering expeditions and claiming substantial royal shares of captured treasure while officially offering polite diplomatic denials to Spanish ambassadors.

[6.3] *1577–1580*

The Golden Hind: Drake's Oceanic Voyage, Pacific Plunder and the Plymouth Return

> ***"Why did Drake's circumnavigation represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?"***

In November 1577, Francis Drake embarked on his legendary circumnavigation voyage as **five ships sail from Plymouth (1577)** on a mission to disrupt Spanish commerce in South America. Navigating through the treacherous Strait of Magellan, his flagship Pelican survived terrifying storms that sank or drove back the other vessels, prompting Drake to rename his ship the *Golden Hind*. Entering the Pacific, Drake launched devastating, **uncharted Pacific raids on Peru**, looting undefended ports and capturing the Spanish treasure galleon Nuestra Señora de la Concepción. When the **Cacafuego surrenders £140,000 treasure** in silver bullion and gemstones, Drake sailed across the Pacific and Indian oceans, arriving home in September 1580 as the first Englishman to circumnavigate the globe.

[6.4] *1580–1581*

The Deptford Knighting: Elizabeth's Defiance, Philip's Outrage and the £10,000 Reward

"How did events in Europe between 1580 and 1584 increase the threat of a Spanish invasion?"

Drake's safe return aboard the treasure-laden *Golden Hind* presented Elizabeth with a monumental foreign policy dilemma. Spanish ambassador Mendoza furiously demanded that Drake be hanged as a common pirate and all looted bullion returned. Defiantly rejecting Spanish ultimatums, Elizabeth visited the explorer in April 1581, **boarding Golden Hind at Deptford (1581)** before thousands of cheering London citizens. In a calculated act of diplomatic provocation, Elizabeth invited the **French ambassador confers knighthood** upon Drake, symbolizing an Anglo-French alignment against Madrid. The Queen awarded Drake a generous **£10,000 royal reward & Spanish fury**, using her massive half-share of the plunder to pay off England's foreign debt and investing the remainder in naval defense, infuriating Philip II.

[6.5] *1584–1585*

The Alliance Hardens: The French Catholic League, Joinville and the Treaty of Nonsuch

"Why did the Treaty of Nonsuch mark the point of no return for war between England and Spain?"

In July 1584, the European balance of power shattered with the tragic **assassination of William of Orange (1584)** by a Catholic fanatic in Delft, leaving the Dutch Protestant Revolt on the verge of total collapse. Months later, Philip II allied with the French Catholic League in the **Secret Treaty of Joinville (Dec 1584)**, creating a united Catholic alliance that completely isolated Protestant England. Recognizing that a Spanish conquest of the Netherlands would leave England vulnerable to imminent invasion, Elizabeth abandoned her previous caution and signed the Treaty of Nonsuch in August 1585. The Queen dispatched **7,400 English troops under Dudley (1585)** to fight alongside Dutch rebels, bringing England and Spain into an open, undeclared war across the Low Countries.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Asymmetric Maritime Aggression • State-Sanctioned Piracy and Dutch Strategic Buffer Defense**

By backing privateers who raided Spanish treasure routes and knighting Francis Drake in public defiance of Philip II, Elizabeth provoked open war to defend England's geopolitical frontiers.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

Why did direct English military intervention in the Low Countries force Philip II to launch the "Enterprise of England"?

[7.1] *1585–1586*

The Treaty of Nonsuch: Leicester's Expedition and the Defense of Flushing

> ***"Why did Dudley's campaign in the Netherlands struggle to achieve decisive military success?"***

In December 1585, Robert Dudley arrived in Flushing to take command of English forces, but the campaign was immediately crippled by political controversy. Dudley accepted the supreme title of Governor-General of the United Provinces, an unauthorized act where the **Governor-General title angers Elizabeth** because it implied she sought sovereign imperial control over Dutch territory without royal permission. Militarily, Elizabeth's refusal to supply adequate funds led to **underfunded & deserting English troops**, who died of starvation and winter fevers without pay. Despite logistical chaos, Dudley's presence achieved one vital strategic success: his army successfully **prevents Parma capturing deep ports** along the Scheldt estuary, denying the Spanish invasion fleet access to vital deep-water Dutch harbours for the Armada.

[7.2] *1586–1587*

Disaster in the Low Countries: Zutphen, Desertions and Leicester's Resignation

> ***"How did English betrayals and command disputes damage relations with the Dutch rebels?"***

English military prestige in the Low Countries collapsed during the bloody siege of Zutphen in September 1586, where courtier-poet **Sir Philip Sidney killed at Zutphen** during a heroic cavalry charge. Worse disaster followed in January 1587 when **Stanley & Yorke betray Dutch forts**, handing the fortified stronghold of Deventer and the redoubt of Zutphen directly to Spanish forces without firing a shot. This catastrophic betrayal alienated Netherlandish allies, creating insurmountable **Dutch Council of State distrust** toward English leadership and convincing Dutch regents that English commanders could not be trusted to defend their independence. Facing intense hostility from Dutch authorities and unable to check Spanish military advances, Dudley was recalled to England in deep political humiliation.

[7.3] *1587*

Singeing the King of Spain's Beard: Drake's Daring Raid on Cadiz Harbour

> ***"How did Drake's tactical boldness at Cadiz disrupt the Spanish invasion timetable?"***

In April 1587, learning that King Philip II was massing an invasion fleet, Elizabeth dispatched Francis Drake with twenty-four warships to disrupt Spanish naval preparations. Sailing audaciously into Cadiz harbour, Drake executed his famous **'Singeing the King of Spain's Beard'**, launching surprise broadside attacks against moored transport vessels before Spanish coastal batteries could coordinate an effective tactical defense. During the raid, over **thirty Spanish warships destroyed** alongside merchant supply ships, after which Drake captured valuable Portuguese coastal plunder. Most critically, Drake captured and incinerated tons of naval supplies, an audacious strike that successfully **postpones Armada by twelve months**, granting the English navy invaluable time to mobilize race-built galleons and train county militias for national defense.

[7.4] *1587–1588*

The Logistical Shock: Seasoned Barrel Hoops, Scorched Fleets and Spanish Delay

> ***"Why were logistical damage and command changes fatal to the Spanish invasion plan?"***

Philip II devised an ambitious invasion plan to conquer England, massing 130 warships in Lisbon. However, logistical preparations were crippled by Drake's raid, during which tons of **seasoned barrel staves incinerated** in Portuguese harbours. Spanish coopers were forced to build water barrels from green, unseasoned wood, producing disastrous leaks and contaminating precious drinking water and food provisions during the voyage. Organizational leadership suffered a devastating blow when veteran admiral **Santa Cruz dies; Medina Sidonia inexperienced** in naval warfare was appointed supreme commander, repeatedly begging to be relieved of command. Consequently, when the fleet departed, unseasoned barrels caused **rotting food & leaking water casks**, leaving thousands of Spanish sailors suffering from dysentery and scurvy before reaching the English Channel.

[7.5] *1588*

The Enterprise of England: Medina Sidonia Assembles the Great Fleet at Lisbon

> ***"What strategic flaws made Philip II's plan to link the fleet with Parma extremely risky?"***

In May 1588, the 'Great and Most Fortunate Navy' sailed from Lisbon, but bad weather forced the fleet into Corunna for urgent repairs. In July 1588, **130 ships & 30,000 men sail** toward England, maintaining a disciplined seven-mile-wide crescent formation designed to protect sluggish troop transports and store vessels from English boarding attacks in the open sea. Yet the invasion plan suffered from a fatal logistical flaw: the Duke of **Parma lacks deep-water harbor in shallows** around Dunkirk, leaving his flat-bottomed invasion barges vulnerable to Dutch gunboats. Because Philip relied on an **unreliable 48-hour message relay** carried by couriers on horseback, Medina Sidonia could not coordinate the precise moment of arrival with Parma's waiting invasion army.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Logistical Disruption • Drake's Preemptive Strike and the Fragility of Oceanic Staging**

Although Leicester's expedition in the Netherlands floundered, Drake's daring 1587 raid on Cadiz destroyed critical shipping and barrel staves, buying England sixteen vital months to prepare.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

Was the defeat of the Spanish Armada primarily the result of superior English naval technology or catastrophic Spanish command and weather?

[8.1] *1588*

The Crescent Advances: Channel Skirmishes from Plymouth to the Isle of Wight

> ***"Why were English ships unable to break the Armada's crescent formation in open Channel water?"***

On 29 July 1588, the Spanish Armada was sighted off the coast of Cornwall. Medina Sidonia anchored his fleet in an impenetrable **seven-mile crescent defensive line**, placing heavy galleons on the outer flanks to shield vulnerable transport ships. The English fleet under Lord Howard of Effingham and Francis Drake slipped out of Plymouth harbour and pursued the Spanish up the Channel. For six days, English captains conducted a **long-range culverin duel beyond boarding**, firing heavy iron broadsides while using superior maneuverability to prevent Spanish soldiers from grappling and boarding. Crucially, the English fleet **prevented landing on Isle of Wight**, forcing Medina Sidonia to abandon plans to establish a safe anchorage and driving the Spanish fleet into open, exposed waters off Calais.

[8.2] *1588*

Midnight at Calais Roads: Hell-Burners, Severed Anchors and Broken Formation

> ***"Why did the English use of fireships at Calais prove the decisive turning point of the campaign?"***

On 6 August 1588, the Armada anchored in Calais Roads, awaiting news from the Duke of Parma whose troops were still not embarked. Recognizing the Spanish vulnerability at anchor, English commanders launched a daring midnight tactical assault, unleashing **eight pitch-soaked vessels at midnight** packed with gunpowder, pitch, and loaded cannons, drifting directly toward the packed Spanish crescent on the rising tide. Terrified of floating explosive hell-burners, **panic-stricken Spanish ships cut anchors** and scattered into the dark sea. While no Spanish galleons were set ablaze, the fleet fell into total disarray, drifting northeastward toward dangerous Flemish shoals where the **shattered crescent never reforms**, leaving individual Spanish vessels isolated and vulnerable to concentrated close-range English broadside attack.

[8.3] *1588*

The Bloodbath at Gravelines: Hawkins' Race-Built Galleons and Close-Range Broadside

> ***"How did English ship design and gunnery tactics defeat Spanish warships at Gravelines?"***

At dawn on 8 August 1588, the decisive Battle of Gravelines commenced off the Flemish coast. Lord Howard, Drake, and Hawkins closed in with **fast English race-built galleons**, designed by John Hawkins with low forecastles and nimble lines that out-sailed the bulky Spanish carracks in rough waters and executed rapid turns under fire with supreme maneuverability. Taking full tactical advantage of disordered Spanish lines, the English maintained **rapid-fire broadside gunnery close range**, firing repeated heavy culverin rounds while Spanish crews struggled to reload their unwieldy, mixed cannons under relentless bombardment. With **three galleons sunk & fleet scattered**, Medina Sidonia was forced into deep water, his ships bloodied and battered, with over two thousand Spanish sailors dead or wounded.

[8.4] *1588*

The Protestant Wind: The Ordeal of the Scottish Isles and Shipwrecks on Irish Rocks

> ***"Why did the combination of adverse weather and lost equipment destroy the retreating Armada?"***

Following Gravelines, a sudden shift in wind prevented Medina Sidonia from rejoining Parma or returning through the English Channel. A **gale-force 'Protestant Wind' drives north**, forcing the surviving Spanish fleet into a perilous journey around the uncharted coasts of northern Scotland and western Ireland in freezing Atlantic gales with exhausted, sick crews and severely damaged ships. Having cut their anchor cables at Calais, Spanish captains suffered catastrophic consequences from **missing anchors on Scottish & Irish reefs**, where dozens of battered galleons were smashed helplessly against jagged cliffs in violent Atlantic squalls. Ultimately, **only sixty-seven battered ships return** to Spain, half the original fleet destroyed and over eleven thousand men lost to drowning, wounds, and starvation.

[8.5] *1588–1589*

The Protestant Deliverance: Elizabeth at Tilbury, Medals of Gold and English Triumph

> ***"How did the defeat of the Armada transform Elizabeth's reputation at home and abroad?"***

The miraculous defeat of the Spanish Armada was celebrated across Protestant Europe as divine deliverance. Elizabeth solidified national unity by delivering her immortal **Tilbury Speech: 'Heart & Stomach of a King'** to assembled troops in Essex, projecting sovereign defiance and courage in the face of foreign Catholic tyranny while wearing polished silver armor before thousands of cheering soldiers. Commemorative medallions were struck bearing the famous legend **'God blew and they were scattered' medals**, attributing victory to Protestant providence. With English survival guaranteed, national pride surged and **English naval superpower prestige secured**, marking England's historic emergence as a premier Atlantic maritime power and ending Philip II's dream of imposing Catholic rule on the British Isles.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Naval Gunfire Revolution • Race-Built Maneuverability, Fireship Disruption, and Atlantic Tempests**

Hawkins' race-built galleons and fast-reloading culverins outmatched the cumbersome Spanish fleet, while hell-burners at Calais and lethal northern gales completed the Armada's destruction.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

How did educational expansion and popular theatrical culture transform English social and civic life?

[9.1] *1558–1588*

Humanism & The Hornbook: The Printing Press, Illiteracy and the Protestant Drive for Reading

> ***"Why did Elizabethan attitudes towards social hierarchy limit educational opportunity?"***

In sixteenth-century England, formal education was strictly stratified by social hierarchy and gender rather than universal entitlement. Overall national literacy remained low, standing at approximately **literacy at 30% for men & 10% for women**, though literacy was considerably higher among London merchants and landed gentry who required reading skills for commercial contracts, estate accounts, and legal disputes. Working-class children occasionally attended informal **petty schools & dame schools for basics**, run in private homes by literate women to teach elementary English reading, catechism, and hornbook prayers. However, schooling was explicitly designed around **reinforcing Great Chain of Being**, teaching children to accept their assigned social station and obey their social superiors in accordance with divine order.

[9.2] *1558–1588*

The Latin Grammar School: Rote Chant, Birch Rods and the Making of the Tudor Elite

> ***"How did grammar schools provide a route for sons of the gentry and merchants to rise in society?"***

The Elizabethan era witnessed a dramatic expansion of secondary grammar schools across the nation, with **over seventy new endowed schools founded** by wealthy philanthropic benefactors and municipal trade guilds in prosperous English market towns. Attended exclusively by boys from yeoman, merchant, and gentry families, these institutions provided a rigorous classical education aimed at producing literate clerks, clergymen, and town administrators. The demanding academic curriculum focused heavily on **Latin grammar & classical rhetoric curriculum**, requiring students to memorize Roman authors like Cicero, translate classical texts, and compose formal speeches. This academic training created unprecedented opportunities for **social mobility for middling sons**, enabling talented grammar school pupils from modest merchant backgrounds to enter university and prestigious royal administrative careers.

[9.3] *1558–1588*

Oxford, Cambridge & The Inns of Court: Gentlemen Scholars, Lawyers and Private Tutors

> ***"How did the education of the nobility differ from schooling provided to the middling classes?"***

The children of wealthy nobility received early schooling at home from **private tutors in noble households**, studying modern European foreign languages, court etiquette, history, and horsemanship. Noble daughters were educated privately in music, needlework, French, and household management, preparing them for dynastic marriages, but were strictly barred from attending public grammar schools and higher university education. For young gentlemen, the apex of higher education was marked by **Oxford & Cambridge college expansions**, where endowed colleges provided classical degrees and trained Anglican clergy. Many wealthy gentry sons subsequently entered the **Inns of Court London legal training** institutions (such as Gray's Inn and the Inner Temple) to study common law, gaining vital legal expertise for managing landed family estates.

[9.4] *1558–1588*

Blood Sports and Tavern Dice: Football Brawls, Cockfighting and Aristocratic Hunting

> ***"How did leisure pursuits reflect both deep social divisions and shared national culture?"***

Elizabethan leisure pastimes were sharply divided along rigid social class boundaries. Wealthy aristocrats enjoyed expensive aristocratic pursuits, engaging in **hunting, hawking & fencing for elites**, alongside courtly dancing, chess, and jousting tournaments designed to showcase chivalric grace, physical stamina, and aristocratic wealth within the prestigious environment of the royal court and grand country manors. In contrast, working-class commoners engaged in rough seasonal pastimes, participating in **violent folk football & archery for commoners** on parish saints' days without standardized rules or pitch boundaries. Spectator blood sports bridged social divisions, drawing enthusiastic crowds from all ranks of society to Southwark amphitheaters for **universal Paris Garden bear-baiting**, where spectators wagered heavily on mastiffs fighting chained bears.

[9.5] *1558–1588*

The Elizabethan Playhouse: Commercial Theatres, Groundlings and Puritan Opposition

> ***"Why did the theatre attract enormous popularity while provoking intense Puritan opposition?"***

The golden age of Elizabethan drama began in 1576 when actor James **Burbage builds 'The Theatre' at Shoreditch**, creating the first purpose-built commercial playhouse in London outside the restrictive jurisdiction of puritanical city aldermen. Permanent open-air playhouses like the Curtain, the Rose, and the Globe revolutionized urban leisure, transforming traveling troupes into celebrated professional repertory companies licensed by noble patrons. The theater was uniquely democratic: for one penny, working-class **penny groundlings mingle with box gentry**, standing side-by-side in the open yard while wealthy nobles sat in tiered covered galleries. However, zealous **Puritans condemn immorality & plague risk**, claiming theaters encouraged sinful drunkenness, sexual temptation, criminal pickpocketing, and spread deadly bubonic plagues among packed urban London crowds.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Cultural Democratisation • The Growth of Vernacular Literacy and Commercial Mass Entertainment**

The rapid rise of grammar schools and open-air commercial playhouses like The Globe created a common cultural language uniting nobility and groundlings across social divides.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

Why did the Tudor state transition from brutal punishment of vagrants to institutional poor relief in the 1570s?

[10.1] *1558–1588*

The Hungry Generation: Population Explosion, Harvest Failures and Soaring Bread Prices

"How did the relationship between population growth and food supply generate severe poverty?"

The central economic catalyst for Elizabethan poverty was a severe demographic surge, as England's **population surges from 3m to over 4m** during Elizabeth's reign. This massive thirty-five percent demographic expansion created chronic national food shortages and heightened land competition, placing unprecedented strain on an agrarian economy unable to increase grain production quickly enough to feed growing urban populations. The crisis was compounded when **consecutive bad harvests inflate grain prices** during the 1570s and 1590s, quadrupling the cost of basic bread. Food price inflation coincided with severe wage stagnation and **falling real wages for farm labourers**, whose purchasing power collapsed, driving hundreds of thousands of impoverished rural families into destitution, malnutrition, and desperate wandering vagrancy.

[10.2] *1558–1588*

Enclosure and Rural Poverty: Sheep Farming, Rising Rents and Displaced Villagers

"Why did the expansion of sheep farming cause widespread rural unemployment and eviction?"

Agrarian changes accelerated rural displacement across the English countryside. The booming woolen cloth trade proved far more profitable than arable farming, as raw **wool accounts for 80% of English exports** to European cloth markets. Consequently, wealthy landowners replaced labor-intensive wheat crops with sheep farming, **hedging common land for low-labour flocks** that required only a single shepherd instead of dozens of agricultural laborers. Enclosure of common fields led to the widespread **eviction of strip-farming tenant cottagers**, who lost their customary grazing rights and were forced off ancestral family holdings. Stripped of their livelihood, dispossessed tenant farmers migrated to overcrowded cities like London in search of employment, swelling the ranks of homeless wandering beggars and terrifying Tudor authorities.

[10.3] *1558–1588*

The Fear of Vagrancy: 'Deserving Poor' vs 'Idle Beggars' and Social Anxieties

"Why did Elizabethan authorities draw such a sharp distinction between the 'deserving' and 'idle' poor?"

Elizabethan society categorized the impoverished into two distinct moral classes: the **impotent poor versus sturdy beggars**. The impotent poor (the elderly, orphans, and the physically disabled) were viewed with Christian compassion and deemed worthy of parish relief. Conversely, sturdy vagabonds capable of physical labor were condemned as criminal loafers, deceitful malingerers, and dangerous threats to social order. Ruling-class paranoia was inflamed by sensationalist pamphlets like Thomas **Harman's Caveat for Common Cursitors book** (1567), which detailed fraudulent beggar tricks like counterfeit cranks foaming with soap. Magistrates were gripped by constant **dread of social unrest & treasonous riot**, fearing that desperate wandering bands of vagrants would unite into organized rebel armies and spark armed insurrection.

[10.4] *1558–1588*

Branded with the Red-Hot Iron: The 1572 Vagabonds Act and Compulsory Poor Rates

> *"How did the 1572 Act combine harsh criminal punishment with the first compulsory tax for relief?"*

In response to mounting urban disorder and the aftermath of the Northern Rebellion, Parliament passed the aggressive 1572 Vagabonds Act. The statute introduced the first **compulsory parish poor rate tax**, making it a legal obligation for wealthy local property owners to pay weekly poor rates, with municipal **overseers appointed to distribute relief** to registered impotent poor in every parish. Crucially, the legislation imposed draconian punishments upon unlicensed sturdy beggars to eradicate vagrancy. Unemployed vagrants over the age of fourteen were publicly whipped and subjected to **ear-boring with hot iron for repeat vagrants**, burning a half-inch hole through their gristle. A second conviction carried felony imprisonment, while third-time offenders faced execution as convicted felons.

[10.5] *1558–1588*

Raw Wool and the House of Correction: The 1576 Act and the Foundations of Modern Welfare

> *"Why did the 1576 Act represent a major shift in the state's responsibility for unemployment?"*

Recognizing that physical punishment alone could not eliminate poverty when jobs did not exist, Parliament passed the constructive 1576 Act for Relief of the Poor. The statute distinguished clearly between those willing to work and idle rogues, legally requiring that **parishes provide raw wool, flax & hemp** so the able-bodied unemployed could earn wages through textile spinning at home. For stubborn vagrants who refused employment, the act mandated that every county establish **county Bridewells compel hard labour**, housing houses of correction where offenders were whipped and forced to perform punishing physical labor. This twin system of punitive correction and work creation laid the vital **foundation for comprehensive 1601 Poor Law** that governed English social welfare for two centuries.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Institutional Paternalism • Compulsory Parish Taxation and Statutory Differentiation of Poverty**

Driven by terrified perceptions of roaming vagabond armies, the Elizabethan state pioneered compulsory local taxation and distinguished between the impotent and idle poor.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

How did technological navigation and oceanic privateering establish England as an emerging global maritime power?

[11.1] *1558–1575*

Navigating the Ocean Sea: Astrolabes, Magnetic Compasses and Mercator's Projection

> ***"How did advances in navigational science make oceanic exploration feasible for English captains?"***

The dramatic expansion of Elizabethan overseas exploration was propelled by major breakthroughs in scientific navigation, astronomy, and cartography. English navigators adopted advanced mathematical instruments, using brass **astrolabes & quadrants measure latitude** by tracking the celestial altitude of the sun and Polaris, enabling captains to determine their precise north-south position upon vast open oceans without sight of land. Oceanic navigation was further transformed by Gerardus **Mercator projection global maps (1569)**, which plotted true compass bearings as straight lines on maritime charts for mariners. Alongside improved magnetic compasses, log lines for estimating speed, and published astronomical tables, these technical innovations made reliable **navigation away from known coastlines** possible, opening transatlantic trade routes to English mariners.

[11.2] *1558–1577*

The Race-Built Galleon: John Hawkins' Low Forecastles, Lateen Sails and Heavy Culvers

> ***"How did changes in galleon design and gun placement give English sailors an advantage at sea?"***

English naval architecture underwent a profound technological revolution under experienced master shipwrights like John Hawkins. Traditional cumbersome, high-castled carracks were replaced by nimble, 'race-built' galleons featuring **low forecastles & triangular lateen sails** combined with square rigging, dramatically lowering water resistance and enabling exceptional speed in heavy Atlantic swells while preventing ships from capsizing in sudden squalls. These innovative warships were mounted with powerful long-range **culverin cannons on four-wheel carriages**, allowing gunners to fire heavy iron broadsides and reload rapidly on protected gun decks during battle. This superior naval engineering allowed **manoeuvrable tacking in severe Atlantic weather**, enabling English captains to fire repeated devastating broadsides while easily out-sailing larger, sluggish Spanish vessels in ocean combat.

[11.3] *1550s–1570s*

The Quest for Cathay: The Muscovy Company, Guinea Gold and the Northwest Passage

> ***"Why did English merchants establish joint-stock companies to explore new global trade routes?"***

English exploration was driven by urgent commercial desperation following the catastrophic **collapse of Antwerp cloth market (1550s)**, which had traditionally absorbed seventy-five percent of English woolen exports. To bypass Spanish and Portuguese trade monopolies, English merchants founded innovative chartered enterprises, establishing the **Muscovy & Levant joint-stock companies** to pioneer profitable trade with Russia, Persia, and the Ottoman Empire. Concurrently, intrepid maritime explorers like Martin **Frobisher & Davis Arctic Northwest search** undertook perilous expeditions through freezing Arctic waters to locate a northern maritime passage to the rich spice markets of China and India. Although they failed to discover a navigable passage, their voyages greatly expanded English geographical knowledge and established valuable Arctic whaling fisheries.

[11.4] *1577–1580*

Around the Globe: Drake's Golden Hind, the Straits of Magellan and Nova Albion

> *"Why did Drake's circumnavigation represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?"*

In December 1577, Francis Drake sailed from Plymouth with five ships on an expedition to raid Spanish commerce in South America. After an arduous Atlantic crossing, his flagship **Pelican renamed Golden Hind at Horn** was the only vessel to survive the terrifying **Strait of Magellan gale storm survival**, where ferocious headwinds wrecked one companion ship and forced the others to turn back. Sailing northward along the Pacific coast of South America, Drake plundered undefended Spanish ports in Chile and Peru, capturing the treasure galleon *Cacafuego*. Continuing north to seek the Northwest Passage, Drake **claims Nova Albion (California) for Crown** in June 1579, naming the territory after England before sailing westward across the Pacific and Indian oceans.

[11.5] *1580–1588*

The Spoils of the Pacific: Stolen Silver, King Philip's Humiliation and Global Geopolitics

> *"How did the success of Drake's circumnavigation alter England's position on the world stage?"*

When Drake sailed the *Golden Hind* into Plymouth in September 1580, his monumental three-year circumnavigation achieved enormous geopolitical, strategic, and financial significance. His vast **£140,000 Spanish bullion cargo returns** stunned Europe, generating an extraordinary **4,700% financial profit pays Crown debt**, wiping out foreign loans, handsomely enriching syndicate investors, and filling Elizabeth's royal treasury with silver and emeralds. Beyond colossal commercial wealth, the epic voyage shattered the enduring myth of Spanish maritime invincibility across the Americas. By successfully navigating the Pacific Ocean and challenging King Philip II's imperial trade monopoly, Drake's triumphant voyage **proves England can challenge Spanish seas**, establishing English naval prestige and inspiring a whole generation of daring Elizabethan Atlantic explorers and privateers.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Cartographic Mastery • Joint-Stock Investment, Long-Range Navigation, and Global Trade Penetration**

Advances in magnetic instrumentation, race-built ship design, and chartered joint-stock ventures enabled English mariners to break Iberian trade monopolies across three oceans.

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION

Why did Walter Raleigh's attempts to establish a permanent English colony on Roanoke Island end in complete disaster?

[12.1] *1584*

The Imperial Vision: Raleigh's Royal Patent, Arthur Barlowe's Expedition and Virginia

> ***"Why did Raleigh and the Elizabethan court believe an American colony was vital to England?"***

In March 1584, Queen Elizabeth granted her charismatic court favorite, Sir Walter Raleigh, a royal charter with a **six-year patent to claim uncharted land** in North America not possessed by any Christian prince. Although forbidden by the Queen from sailing in person, Raleigh invested substantial wealth and recruited key investors to finance an ambitious colonial settlement named Virginia in honor of the Virgin Queen. Raleigh's imperial vision was deeply shaped by geographer Richard **Hakluyt's Discourse on Western Planting** (1584), which argued that an American colony would provide an ideal **privateering base to intercept Spanish plate** fleets, export surplus unemployed English laborers, and supply valuable timber and hemp for royal naval construction, breaking Spanish imperial hegemony in the New World.

[12.2] *1584–1585*

Mismatched Colonists: Soldiers, Alchemists, Grenville's Command and Lane's Fort

> ***"Why did the social composition and skills of the 1585 colonists create severe vulnerabilities?"***

In April 1585, Raleigh dispatched an expedition of seven vessels under the overall naval command of his cousin, Sir Richard Grenville. However, recruitment was fundamentally flawed, assembling **107 gentlemen soldiers & no farmers** who were accustomed to military garrison life or aristocratic leisure rather than the grueling manual agricultural labor required to clear virgin forests and cultivate crops in unfamiliar wilderness. Friction quickly erupted between the fiery naval commander of the **Grenville fleet & Ralph Lane army discipline**, whose harsh martial laws provoked resentment among settlers. The colony relied crucially on two Native American Algonquians, **Manteo & Wanchese native translators**, brought to London in 1584, though the two men held starkly divided opinions regarding English intentions in Virginia.

[12.3] *1585–1586*

Shoals and Spoiled Corn: The Tiger Wreck, Food Shortages and Secotan Hostility

> ***"How did environmental accidents and food dependency undermine the first Roanoke settlement?"***

The Roanoke settlement was doomed by bad luck and poor navigation upon arrival in June 1585. While navigating the treacherous Outer Banks of North Carolina, the **flagship Tiger runs aground on sandbar** at Ocracoke Inlet. Seawater flooded the hold, where **seawater ruins grain seeds & provisions**, destroying nearly all agricultural seed crops, livestock, and foodstuffs intended to sustain the settlers through their first winter. Unable to grow their own grain, the colonists faced immediate starvation, resulting in a **disastrous reliance on Secotan fish weirs** and corn supplies from local Indigenous villages. Settlers lacked the wilderness skills to catch fish or forage wild food, placing unsustainable demands on Secotan chiefdoms whose own winter food reserves were severely stretched by the uninvited European settlers.

[12.4] *1586*

The Severed Thread: The Death of Wingina, Drake's Rescue and the First Evacuation

> ***"Why did armed conflict with the Secotan force the complete abandonment of the 1585 colony?"***

Tensions between colonists and local Secotan tribes soon erupted into deadly violence. Following an accusation that an Indigenous villager had stolen a silver cup, Grenville ordered a punitive raid where a **silver cup dispute leads to village burning** and corn fields destroyed. Relations disintegrated under Ralph Lane's paranoid military command, culminating in a preemptive strike where a **Ralph Lane ambush kills Chief Wingina**. Terrified of massive tribal retaliation and facing acute starvation, the settlers' morale collapsed completely. In June 1586, when Sir Francis **Drake arrives to evacuate starving settlers** following his successful Caribbean privateering raid, the exhausted colonists abandoned Roanoke and boarded his fleet, bringing the disastrous first colonial venture in North America to an ignominious end.

[12.5] *1587–1590*

The Lost Colony: John White's Families, the Armada Embargo and the Mystery of CROATOAN

> ***"What crucial lessons did the failure of the Roanoke expeditions provide for future English colonies?"***

Undeterred, Raleigh launched a second expedition in 1587, sending **118 civilian settlers led by John White**, including seventeen women and children who represented a genuine farming community. White established a colony on Roanoke Island, where his granddaughter Virginia Dare was born. When White returned to England for supplies, the outbreak of war with Spain intervened, as the **Armada impounds supply ships in England**. White was trapped in England for three years until 1590, when he finally returned to Roanoke to find the settlement completely deserted, with the single word **'CROATOAN' carved on deserted palisade** posts. While the Roanoke enterprise collapsed tragically as the 'Lost Colony', Raleigh's pioneering experiments laid the essential organizational foundations for successful permanent English colonization at Jamestown in 1607.

DISCIPLINARY CAUSAL EVALUATION **Colonial Fragility • Mismatched Colonist Skills, Severe Logistical Interruption, and Indigenous Alienation**

Unprepared aristocratic settlers, loss of seed stores during the Tiger shipwreck, hostile relations with the Secotan, and the 1588 Armada embargo doomed the first English settlement in America.

MASTER KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL QUIZ • 1558–1588

60 CORE RETRIEVAL QUESTIONS

PARTNER QUIZ OR SOLO PRACTICE: Read each question aloud. State the exact historical fact, individual, or date. Cross-check paragraph references to verify your answers. Zero marks awarded for vague generalisations.

TOPIC CARD 1 pp. 4–7 • Ref [1.1]–[2.5]

Queen, Government & The 1559 Settlement

1. In what month and year did twenty-five-year-old Elizabeth I ascend the throne?
2. Approximately how much Crown debt did Elizabeth inherit from Mary I in 1558?
3. Which European financial exchange lent money to the English Crown at 14% interest?
4. Whom did Elizabeth appoint as her trusted Principal Secretary on her accession day?
5. How many senior advisors sat on Elizabeth's executive Privy Council?
6. Which English continental outpost in France was lost in January 1558?
7. What title did Elizabeth assume under the 1559 Act of Supremacy?
8. What fine was imposed under the 1559 Act of Uniformity for failing to attend Sunday church?
9. What liturgical book was made compulsory in all English parish churches in 1559?
10. What official visitations were launched in 1559 to enforce the Royal Injunctions?

TOPIC CARD 2 pp. 8–11 • Ref [3.1]–[4.5]

Religion Challenges, Recusancy & Mary Stuart

11. What term describes devout English Catholics who refused to attend Anglican church services?
12. How many London preachers were suspended by Archbishop Parker in the 1566 Vestments Crisis?
13. In which Spanish Netherlands town was an English Catholic seminary college established in 1568?
14. Which Spanish commander led 10,000 veteran troops (tercios) into the Netherlands in 1567?
15. In what month and year did Mary, Queen of Scots flee across the Solway Firth into England?
16. In which fortified castle in the Yorkshire Dales was Mary Stuart first held under custody?
17. What scandalous documents were presented at the 1568 York Inquiry accusing Mary of murder?
18. At which house outside Edinburgh was Lord Darnley murdered in February 1567?
19. Which Scottish Protestant earl led the rebel lords who forced Mary's abdication at Lochleven?
20. Why did Elizabeth refuse to pass a definitive guilty or innocent verdict at the Westminster Inquiry?

TOPIC CARD 3 pp. 12–13 • Ref [5.1]–[5.5]

Northern Rebellion, Plots & Mary's Execution

21. Which two Catholic Northern Earls led the November 1569 Northern Rebellion?
22. In which northern cathedral did the rebel Earls tear up English prayer books and celebrate Mass?
23. Approximately how many northern rebels were executed under martial law by royal order in 1570?
24. What papal bull was issued by Pope Pius V in February 1570 excommunicating Elizabeth?
25. Which Italian banker orchestrated an international Catholic conspiracy to invade England in 1571?
26. Which high-ranking English peer was executed on Tower Hill in June 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot?
27. What 1584 pledge bound English subjects to execute anyone plotting against Elizabeth's life?
28. Which young Catholic conspirator used hidden beer-barrel ciphers to communicate with Mary Stuart in 1586?
29. Who served as Elizabeth's ruthless Spymaster that cracked the Babington ciphers?
30. In which Northamptonshire castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587?

TOPIC CARD 4 pp. 14–17 • Ref [6.1]–[7.5]

Cold War with Spain, Privateering & War

31. What lucrative commercial licenses granted courtiers exclusive rights to trade specific goods?
32. What Spanish cargo ship carrying 26 tons of silver bullion was seized by Francis Drake in 1579?
33. What was the name of Drake's flagship in which he completed his 1577–1580 global circumnavigation?
34. At which royal dockyard did Queen Elizabeth knight Francis Drake aboard his ship in April 1581?
35. Approximately how much plunder did Drake return to the English treasury following his voyage?
36. What 1584 secret treaty allied Philip II of Spain with the French Catholic League against Protestants?
37. What August 1585 treaty committed Elizabeth to send 7,400 English troops to the Netherlands?
38. Which royal favourite was appointed commander-in-chief of English forces in the Low Countries?
39. In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch his daring preemptive raid in April 1587?
40. How many Spanish warships and supply vessels did Drake destroy during the "singeing of the King's beard"?

TOPIC CARD 5 pp. 18–19 • Ref [8.1]–[8.5]

The Spanish Armada Campaign of 1588

41. Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada following Santa Cruz's death?
42. How many ships and troops made up the Spanish Armada when it sailed from Lisbon in May 1588?
43. Which Spanish general commanded the 30,000 veteran invasion army stationed in the Netherlands?
44. On what date was the Spanish Armada first sighted off the Lizard and Plymouth?
45. What tactical defensive crescent formation did the Armada maintain while sailing up the Channel?
46. What naval weapon did the English deploy at midnight off Calais on 7 August to break the crescent?
47. Which decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 between English and Spanish fleets?
48. What name was given to the north-westerly gale that blew the retreating Armada into the North Sea?
49. Where did Queen Elizabeth deliver her famous speech declaring she had "the heart and stomach of a king"?
50. Approximately how many Spanish ships were destroyed or wrecked along the coasts of Scotland and Ireland?

TOPIC CARD 6 pp. 20–27 • Ref [9.1]–[12.5]

Society, Poverty, Exploration & Virginia

51. What wooden board with alphabet and Lord's Prayer protected by animal horn was used in petty schools?
52. Which prestigious legal institutions in London provided gentlemen with courtly and legal education?
53. Name the first purpose-built London playhouse, erected by James Burbage in Shoreditch in 1576.
54. What term described the open pit yard where poorer Elizabethan playgoers stood for a penny?
55. What agrarian process fenced off common arable land for sheep farming, dispossessing rural labourers?
56. Which 1572 statute introduced whipping, ear-boring, and compulsory parish poor rates for vagrants?
57. What 1576 statute established Houses of Correction (Bridewells) to put the able-bodied poor to work?
58. What technological navigational instrument allowed Elizabethan sailors to calculate latitude at sea?
59. Which courtier and explorer was granted a royal patent by Elizabeth in 1584 to colonise North America?
60. What mysterious single word was found carved into a wooden post at the abandoned Roanoke colony in 1590?